

Lucas Wright

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EDUCATION

2026 (expected)	Ph.D., Communication, Cornell University
2023	MS, Communication, Cornell University
2018	MSc, Social Science of the Internet, University of Oxford
2016	BA, Political Science, American University

PUBLICATIONS

- Wright, L.** (2025). Trust and safety vendors: Looking back and forward. In M. L. Daniel, A. Menking, M. T. Savio, & J. Claffey (Eds.), *Trust, safety, and the internet we share: Multistakeholder insights*. Taylor & Francis. <https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5360109>
- Wright, L.**, Muenster, R. M., Vecchione, B., Qu, T., Cai, P., Smith, A., Investigators, C. 2. S., Metcalf, J., & Matias, J. N. (2024). Null compliance: NYC local law 144 and the challenges of algorithm accountability. *Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency*, 1701–1713. <https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3630106.3658998>
- Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). Impact assessment of human-algorithm feedback loops. *Social Science Research Council*. <https://just-tech.ssrc.org/field-reviews/impact-assessment-of-human-algorithm-feedback-loops/>
- Wright, L.** (2022). Automated platform governance through visibility and scale: On the transformational power of automoderator. *Social Media+ Society*, 8(1), 20563051221077020. <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/full/10.1177/20563051221077020>
- Wright, L.**, Ruths, D., Dillon, K. P., Saleem, H. M., & Benesch, S. (2017). Vectors for counterspeech on twitter. *Proceedings of the first workshop on abusive language online*, 57–62. <https://aclanthology.org/W17-3009.pdf>

UNDER REVIEW

- Wright, L.** (n.d.-a). *Disinformation, security, and the politics of technification*.
- Wright, L.** (n.d.-b). *The salesforce of safety: Software vendors as infrastructural/professional nodes in the field of online trust and safety*.
- Wright, L.**, Matias, J. N., Penney, J., Mou, M. E., & Klein, M. (n.d.). *Automated enforcement of copyright law reduces freedom of expression online*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Wright, L.** (2025a). *The political economy of trust and safety vendors*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Denver, USA.
- Wright, L.** (2025b). *Securitization of information: The universal and objective discourse of cognitive security threats*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Denver, USA.
- Wright, L.** (2024). *The political economy of trust and safety vendors*
Paper presented at the Association of Internet Researchers Conference, Sheffield, England.

- Wright, L.**, Muenster, R. M., Vecchione, B., Qu, T., Cai, P., Smith, A., Investigators, C. 2. S., Metcalf, J., & Matias, J. N. (2024). *Null compliance: NYC local law 144 and the challenges of algorithm accountability*. <https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3630106.3658998>
Paper presented at the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
- Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Impact assessment of human-algorithm feedback loops*.
Conference on Digital Experimentation @ MIT, Virtual.
- Wright, L.** (2022). *Content moderation as spectacle*
Work in progress presented at the International Communication Association, Paris, France.
- Wright, L.**, Matias, J. N., Mou, M. E., Penney, J., & Klein, M. (2021). *Do automated legal threats reduce freedom of expression online? preliminary results from a natural experiment*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Virtual.
- Wright, L.** (2019). *Governing with the AutoModerator bot: A mixed methods study of algorithmic moderation on reddit* [Paper presented at the ICA Rise of Platforms Post Conference, Washington, DC.]
Paper presented at the ICA Rise of Platforms Post Conference, Washington, DC.

POLICY REPORTS

- Constanza, M. V. B., Candela, J. Q., **Wright, L.**, Bogan, L., & Faddoul, M. (2022). *Technology primer: Social media recommendation algorithms*. Edited by Ariel Higuchi, Amritha Jayanti. Belfer Center for Science, and International Affairs, Harvard Kennedy School. <https://www.belfercenter.org/publication/technology-primer-social-media-recommendation-algorithms>
- Matias, J. N., Penney, J., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Comments responding to US copyright office notice of inquiry docket no. 2021-10*. <https://osf.io/498ja/>
- Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Innovation & governance of adaptive AI with community science*
Submission to the U.S. Office of Science and Technology Policy Research and Development Strategic Plan.

SELECTED MEDIA AND BLOG CONTRIBUTIONS

- Shulruff, T., **Wright, L.**, & Lazarus, J. (2025). Online safety depends on a growing trust and safety vendor ecosystem. *Tech Policy Press*. <https://techpolicy.press/online-safety-depends-on-a-growing-trust-and-safety-vendor-ecosystem>
- Wright, L.** (2019). What speech police by david kaye can teach us about YouTube's latest scandal. *Dangerous Speech Project*. <https://www.dangerousspeech.org/libraries/what-speech-police-by-david-kaye-can-teach-us-about-youtubes-latest-scandal>
- Wright, L.** (2017a). Google's new 'toxicity' detecting software signals progress in online speech classifiers. *Dangerous Speech Project*. <https://www.dangerousspeech.org/libraries/googles-new-toxicity-detecting-software-signals-progress-in-online-speech-classifiers>
- Wright, L.** (2017b). Tech can't solve the internet's worst problems—but you can. *Quartz*. <https://qz.com/1125563/tech-cant-solve-the-internets-worst-problems-but-you-can>
- Wright, L.**, Karsten, J., & West, D. M. (2016). A brief history of u.s. encryption policy. *Brookings Institution*. <https://www.brookings.edu/articles/a-brief-history-of-u-s-encryption-policy/>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2023	COMPASS Fellow, National Telecommunications and Information Administration
2020–	Graduate Research Assistant, Citizens and Technology Lab, Cornell University
2019–2020	Senior Researcher, Global Disinformation Index
2019	Research Consultant, Civic Signals Project, New America Foundation

2018–2019	Graduate Research Assistant, Offensive Internet Project, Oxford Internet Institute
2016–2017	Researcher, Dangerous Speech Project
2016	Research Intern, Center for Technology Innovation, Brookings Institution
2015	Elections Research Assistant, Change.org
2014	National Security and Human Rights Intern, Government Accountability Project

AWARDS AND GRANTS

2025	Finalist - NSF Law and Science Dissertation Grant
2024	Recipient - Cornell Graduate School Research Travel Grant
2024	Recipient - Cornell Qualitative and Interpretive Research Institute Research Grant
2020	Cornell Fellowship (one year of funding)
2016	Inducted into <i>Phi Beta Kappa</i>

TEACHING

Fall 2023	Communication and Technology, Cornell University, Instructor
Fall 2022	Research Methods in Communication Studies, Cornell University, Sections Instructor
Fall 2021	Oral Communication, Cornell University, Sections Instructor
Spring 2021	New Media and Society, Cornell University, Instructor
Fall 2020	Media Communication, Cornell University, Instructor
Spring 2017, 2018, 2019	The Idea of the Internet, Harvard University, Instructor

SERVICE

Reviewer, Information, Communication, and Society
Reviewer, Journal of Social Computing
Reviewer, International Communication Association
Reviewer, Association of Internet Researchers
Reviewer, ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

International Communication Association
Association of Internet Researchers
Association for Computing Machinery
Coalition for Independent Technology Research
Graduate Affiliate, UNC Center for Information, Technology, and Public Life